



LAKEWOOD CITY COUNCIL MINUTES

Monday, December 1, 2025

City of Lakewood

6000 Main Street SW

Lakewood, WA 98499

<https://us02web.zoom.us/j/86872632373>

Dial +1(253) 215- 8782 Participant ID: 868 7263 2373

CALL TO ORDER

Mayor Whalen called the meeting to order at 7:00 p.m.

ROLL CALL

Councilmembers Present: 7 – Mayor Jason Whalen, Deputy Mayor Mary Moss, Michael Brandstetter, Ryan Pearson, Patti Belle, J. Trestin Lauricella and Paul Bocchi.

PLEDGE OF ALLEGIANCE

Mayor Whalen paused for a moment of silence, led the Pledge of Allegiance and reflected on the 16th year following the tragic loss of Sargeant Mark Renninger, Officer Tina Griswold, Officer Ronald Owens and Officer Greg Richards, Lakewood Police Department.

COUNCILMEMBER BELLE MOVED TO AMEND THE ORDER OF THE AGENDA TO CONSIDER NEW BUSINESS, MOTION NO. 2025-86 IN ADVANCE OF PROCLAMATIONS AND PRESENTATIONS. SECONDED BY COUNCILMEMBER BOCCHI. VOICE VOTE WAS TAKE AND CARRIED UNANIMOUSLY.

NEW BUSINESS

Motion No. 2025-86 Confirming the appointment of Timothy Lewis as Lakewood Municipal Court Judge and authorizing the execution of an agreement for Municipal Court Judge services.

COUNCILMEMBER PEARSON MOVED TO ADOPT MOTION NO. 2025-86. SECONDED BY DEPUTY MAYOR MOSS. VOICE VOTE WAS TAKEN AND CARRIED UNANIMOUSLY.

PROCLAMATIONS AND PRESENTATIONS

Swearing-In Ceremony.

Mayor Whalen conducted the Oath of Office for Timothy Lewis, Lakewood Municipal Court Judge.

Larry Saunders Service Award Presentation.

Bob Warfield, Lakewood Community Foundation Fund introduced Walter Neary who recognized Ben Sclair for his work publishing the Suburban Times as the 2025 Larry Saunders Service Award recipient.

Bob Warfield, Lakewood Community Foundation Fund then recognized Deputy Mayor Mary Moss for her work as the Founding President of the Lakewood Multicultural Coalition as the 2025 Larry Saunders Service Award recipient.

Proclamation recognizing Ben Sclair, Suburban Times.

MAYOR WHALEN PRESENTED A PROCLAMATION RECOGNIZING BEN SCLAIR, SUBURBAN TIMES.

PUBLIC COMMENTS

The City Council received written comments in advance of the meeting from Christina Manetti, Garry Oak Coalition.

Vicky Stanich, Lakewood resident, shared that there is a family holiday event at the West Pierce Fire Station on Steilacoom Blvd. and encouraged residents to participate in neighborhood association meetings.

Ebrahim Mirjalili, Lakewood resident, spoke about the public boat launch.

At 7:51 p.m., Mayor Whalen announced that the meeting will recess for approximately five minutes. The City Council reconvened at 7:59 p.m.

Christina Manetti, Garry Oak Coalition, expressed concerns regarding the pruning of Garry Oak trees in various locations throughout the City and in support of further tree protections, code amendments preventing harmful pruning and an education program.

Christina Manetti, Lakewood resident, spoke in support of suspending the use of flock automatic license plate readers within the city.

James Dunlop, Lakewood resident, spoke in support of access to public comments, residents being disconnected and in support of preservation of Garry Oak trees.

C O N S E N T A G E N D A

- A. Approval of the minutes of the City Council meeting of November 17, 2025.
- B. Approval of claims vouchers, in the amount of \$3,638,408.31, for the period of October 16, 2025 through November 14, 2025.
- C. Approval of payroll checks, in the amount of \$3,164,633.10, for the period of October 16, 2025 through November 15, 2025.

- D. Motion No. 2025-83

Accepting an Office of Local Defense Community Cooperation grant for the JBLM Growth Implementation II.

- E. Motion No. 2025-84

Authorizing the execution of an agreement with Stantec, in the amount of \$536,400, to accomplish the work outlined in the JBLM Growth Implementation II.

- F. Motion No. 2025-85

Authorizing the execution of an agreement with Washington State Department of Ecology to establish a Stormwater Asset Management System.

- G. Items filed in the Office of the City Clerk:
 - 1. Planning Commission meeting minutes of April 16, 2025.
 - 2. Lakewood's Promise Advisory Board meeting minutes of June 5, 2025.
 - 3. Planning Commission meeting minutes of October 1, 2025.
 - 4. Lakewood's Promise Advisory Board meeting minutes of October 16, 2025.

COUNCILMEMBER PEARSON MOVED TO ADOPT THE CONSENT AGENDA. SECONDED BY COUNCILMEMBER LAURICELLA. VOICE VOTE WAS TAKEN AND CARRIED UNANIMOUSLY.

R E G U L A R A G E N D A**PUBLIC HEARINGS AND APPEALS**

This is the date set for a public hearing on amendments to the Lakewood Municipal Code related to the expansion of childcare locations.

The City Council received written testimony in advance of the meeting from Tricia Parsons.

Speaking before Council were:

Ebrahim Mirjalili, Lakewood resident, spoke in opposition to the expansion of childcare locations.

James Dunlop, Lakewood resident, spoke about unintended consequences of expanding childcare center locations.

Christina Manetti, Lakewood resident, spoke in support of strict environmental and noise regulations to protect residents and balance childcare needs with neighborhood livability.

Christina Manetti, Garry Oak Coalition, spoke in opposition to unmitigated expansion of childcare facilities into residential neighborhoods due to environmental concerns.

There being no further testimony, the public hearing was declared closed at 8:47 p.m.

ORDINANCE

Ordinance No. 838 Granting Forged Fiber 37, LLC a non-exclusive franchise for the transmission of telecommunications in, through, over and under the rights-of-way of the City of Lakewood.

COUNCILMEMBER PEARSON MOVED TO ADOPT ORDINANCE NO. 838. SECONDED BY COUNCILMEMBER BELLE. VOICE VOTE WAS TAKEN AND CARRIED UNANIMOUSLY.

RESOLUTION

Resolution No. 2025-15 Conditionally approving the Station Plaza Apartments Multifamily Tax Exemption.

COUNCILMEMBER PEARSON MOVED TO ADOPT RESOLUTION NO. 2025-15. SECONDED BY COUNCILMEMBER BRANDSTETTER. VOICE VOTE WAS TAKEN AND CARRIED UNANIMOUSLY.

UNFINISHED BUSINESS

None.

REPORTS BY THE CITY MANAGER

City Manager Russell announced the following upcoming meetings and events:

- December 2, 6 P.M., Joint Meeting with State Legislative Agenda, City Council Chambers
- December 3, 7 A.M. to 10 A.M., Employee Recognition Event, McGavick Conference Center
- December 3, 5 P.M. to 8 P.M., Tacoma Pierce County Chamber Public Officials Holiday Reception, Tacoma Art Museum
- December 4, 5:30 P.M., Social Hour 18th Air Force Commander, Major General Charles Bolton, Mrs. Stacey Bolton, McChord Club
- December 6, AWC's Elected Officials Essentials Workshop, various locations and virtual
- December 6, 12 P.M. to 3 P.M., Emergency Food Network Empty Bowls, 3318 92nd Street S, Lakewood
- December 6, 4:30 P.M. to 5:30 P.M., Holiday Parade and Christmas Tree Lighting
- December 10, 5:30 P.M., Downtown Neighborhood Association Meeting, Lakewood Library
- December 13, 9:30 A.M., Jingle Bell Dash & 5K, Fort Steilacoom Park
- December 19, 6:00 P.M., City of Lakewood and 2/2 SBCT Community Connector Holiday Dinner Event, Thornewood Castle

He then requested the City Council review the topics for the Joint meeting with State Legislators and consider who will provide an overview of each topic.

CITY COUNCIL COMMENTS

Councilmember Brandstetter shared that he will attend the Association of Washington Cities Elected Officials Essentials on December 6th in Olympia.

Councilmember Bocchi shared that new reader board sign has been constructed and spoke about Pierce County funding for senior center programming. He shared that he will participate in the Holiday Parade, South Sound Housing Affordability Partners (SSHA³P) meeting, Employee Recognition event and recognized Tavita Pritchard who has been selected as the Head Coach for Stanford.

Councilmember Pearson shared that he attended the Fort Steilacoom Neighborhood Association meeting and will attend the Employee Recognition Event, Pierce County Chamber Elected Officials and Holiday Parade.

Councilmember Lauricella acknowledged those who were recognized this evening and shared that he will attend the Public Safety Advisory Committee meeting and the Holiday Parade.

Councilmember Belle shared that she will attend the Holiday Parade, the Employee Recognition Event and acknowledged the Mayor's comments at the beginning of this evening.

Deputy Mayor Moss thanked those who recognized her this evening, she shared that she will attend the Employee Recognition event, the Holiday Parade and the JBLM Holiday Social.

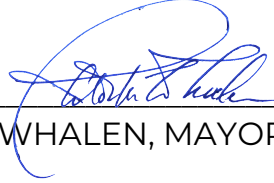
Mayor Whalen shared that he attended the Pierce County Regional Council meeting, a Pierce County Executive In-District meeting and this week he will attend the Employee Recognition Event and the Pierce County Chamber Elected Officials Event. He spoke about Flock Cameras and reduction of crime as a result of the usage of the technology, the reader board display, car events at Colonial Plaza area and shared that he will be interviewing candidates for two Planning Commission vacancies. He shared that he will be out of the office from December 4th through December 12th, attending virtually on December 8th.

Mayor Whalen announced that the City Council will recess into Executive Session for approximately 20 minutes pursuant to RCW 42.30.110(i) to discuss with legal counsel representing the city litigation or potential litigation to which the city, the governing body, or a member acting in an official capacity is, or is likely to become, a party, when public knowledge regarding the discussion is likely to result in an adverse legal or financial consequence to the city. The City Council is not expected to take action following the Executive Session other than to adjourn the

meeting. The City Council recessed at 9:31 p.m. At 9:51, Mayor Whalen announced that the Executive Session will be extended for an additional 20 minutes. At 10:10 p.m., Mayor Whalen extended for an additional 10 minutes. The City Council reconvened at 10:21 p.m.

ADJOURNMENT

There being no further business, the meeting adjourned at 10:21 p.m.



JASON WHALEN, MAYOR

ATTEST:



BRIANA SCHUMACHER
CITY CLERK